

Brandon C Buchanan

Senior Program Manager & Technical Leader in Pharma/Life Sciences IT

Highly accomplished, capable program manager and technical lead with unique stakeholder background specializing in enterprise IT delivery, complex integration architecture, and **data migration** in international regulated environments. Exceptionally adept at scalably leading multiple projects, fostering high-performance teams, and effectively aligning direction with executive sponsors. Combines deep expertise in **ERP**, **PLM**, **QMS**, **MES**, and **LIMS** platforms with hands-on experience as a practicing full-stack software developer.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gilead Sciences (via RGP Consulting) – **Data** Workstream Lead / Senior Project Manager, Sep 2023 – Present

- Directed a **data migration** workstream for a complex supply-chain **ERP implementation** involving 35+ business, technical, and validation resources, ensuring GxP-compliant **data** extraction, transformation, and loading; included routine briefs to CIO-level steering committee.
- Upon entry mid-project, implemented a comprehensive **data** verification strategy and process improvements to reduce risk to scope and go-live date. Developed risk reduction strategies and E2E process/verification line-of-sight while coaching business, technical, and **quality** teams on execution; also directly managed tiger team to execute requirement and ensure project success.
- Introduced several comprehensive E2E **data migration** strategies that included detailed risk frameworks, preload/postload testing protocols, process documentation improvements, and resources; briefed these to CIO-level steering committee.

Moderna (via RED Global) – Program Lead / Senior Project Manager, Apr 2023 – Sep 2023

- Spearheaded a lab integration program incorporating LabVantage, Scitara, LabX, and Chromeleon platforms, successfully aligning technical architecture with business objectives. Facilitated contractual negotiations with vendors to advance program execution.
- Delivered LabX integration project using a hybrid agile/waterfall methodology, reducing project timelines by 2–3 months through efficient planning and execution.
- Rapidly planned and completed a critical LIMS/**SAP** interface readiness project in under one month, leveraging tactical plans and daily stand-ups to meet tight deadlines.

Smith & Nephew (via Vaco) – Senior Project Manager / Technical Lead, Aug 2022 – Apr 2023

- Designed and executed a robust **data migration** architecture and strategy encompassing **SAP**, **Agile**, and **MasterControl systems** into Windchill PLM system.
- Developed and fielded innovative tools for **data** mapping, transformation, and **data** modeling, streamlining **data** validation and ensuring high-**quality migration** results.
- Restructured project plan and reintroduced Agile to streamline project.
- Conducted comprehensive business analysis to elicit requirements and created a detailed end-to-end mapping deliverable to guide **data migration** activities.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Biotechnology
Medical Device
Pharmaceutical
Manufacturing

PM/LEADERSHIP

Proactive risk identification
Project/resource planning
RAID-based execution
Forward indicators
At-a-glance summaries
Sponsor-suitable comms
Agile, waterfall & hybrid

FUNCTIONAL / TECHNICAL Systems Implementation

Roadmapping
Systems Integration
Data Migration
Data Governance
Data Mapping
Data Cleansing
Process Design
Business Analysis
Regulatory Compliance
Master **Data Management**
Life Cycle **Management**
Quality Assurance
User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

CERTIFICATIONS

Project Mgmt (Master's Cert)
Six Sigma Black Belt

PROFESSIONAL TOOLS

MS Project, Smartsheet,
Primavera, Confluence
Jira, ADO, Trello

TECHNICAL TOOLS

C++, Visual C
Visual Basic
SQL, MySQL
MongoDB
Python
Java/JavaScript
XML/HTML

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- Led **data** remediation efforts for failed **migration** executed prior to tenure.

Organon (via Diversant) – Senior Project Manager / Technical Lead , Mar 2022 – Jul 2022

- Designed and fielded a customized **data migration** technical architecture and program to transition records from Trackwise to ETQ Reliance and other **systems**, meeting tight timeline requirements; quickly organized and fielded project plan, program, resource and platform requirements and KPIs.
- Evaluated and onboarded **Syniti's data migration** platform, directing vendor resources and managing system-to-system interactions.
- Developed interim and long-term archival strategies, including custom architectures to ensure platform-independent access to multi-tiered records.

Bristol Myers Squibb (via Eliassen Group) – Senior Project Manager, Oct 2021 – Feb 2022

- Managed/delivered eight FusionQMS program elements, integrating new **quality management** processes across multiple teams; enhanced team capacity via mentorship of junior PMs.
- Conducted gap assessments and optimized QMS policies, streamlining change control and training initiatives.

Merck – Associate Director, **Data** Readiness, Feb 2019 – Oct 2021

- Led **data cleansing**/build and testing project components for integrated, global **SAP S4/HANA** PLM for 24 Merck production sites as joint PM and technical lead across 3+ production releases and including 5000+ test specification records, 5,000 supplier records, 30,000+ material master records and 2500+ specification records
- Led global **SAP S4/HANA** PLM **data migration** projects, delivering 5000+ records per release across 24 production sites. [vendor]
- Developed and implemented a **data** governance framework and approach, gaining approval for same through executive steering committee, and using the program to foster collaboration across **data** owners and stakeholders.
- Developed novel preload/postload validation techniques to ensure the integrity of migrated **data**.
- Designed technical solutions for unstructured **data** streams and built advanced **data quality** reporting tools to streamline project execution.

Novo Nordisk – Senior Project Manager, May 2018 – Feb 2019

- Reengineered direction on cybersecurity remediation initiative, achieving \$1.4M in cost savings and reducing project timelines by over a year.
- Led and optimized MES **implementation** projects, reducing costs by 43% and mentoring newer project managers to ensure smooth transitions.

(Note: work performed from May 2018 to August 2018 was executed for Novo Nordisk under contract to LMN Services, Inc; duties were the same as noted above.)

SOFTWARE PLATFORMS

SAP (S4/**HANA**, R3); SCM - MM, QM, EWM, TM, PLM, BRH, ECM, DMS; OTC; STS; RTR; P2P; MDG

Syniti ADM, Valiance
BODS, LTMC, iDOC
Snowflake, Databricks
Boomi, Tibco
Collibra, Informatica
Werum, Tracksys
Trackwise, ETQ Reliance
Veeva, Documentum
OpenText
LabX, Scitara, Chromeleon
LabVantage, LabWare
Waters Empower, Nugenesis
TotalChrom, Labwatch (Kaye)
Red Prairie, Maximo
Isotrain, SABA

DATA APPROACHES

Strong search algorithms
Regex / regular expressions
Unstructured **data** decomp
Computational linguistics
Self-classifying sets
Machine learning
AI, LLMs, LDMs
Prompt **engineering**

STAKEHOLDER EXPERIENCE

Software validation
Equipment qualification
Line **engineering**
Operations **management**
QA **management**
Supply chain/OPEX
Regulatory change control
Product launch
Labeling / artwork
Packaging **engineering**
Deviations / CAPA
Gap/remediation **engineering**
21 CFR 11, HIPAA, HL7
Trade compliance

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Throne Research LLC – CEO/Principal Consultant, Oct 2017 – May 2018

- Prototyped and launched a scalable **data migration** software platform tailored for pharmaceutical IT **systems** with a novel suite of tools for **data** characterization, mapping and **cleansing**/transformation, including strong search, regex, self-classified dataset analysis, computational linguistics, and machine-learning assessment.
- Designed comprehensive MES and LIMS technical architectures, incorporating **ERP** integration to enhance operational efficiencies.
- Delivered consulting services to top-tier pharmaceutical and healthcare firms, ensuring competitiveness and compliance with regulatory standards.

Previous experience available upon request.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS

(Merck/Schering-Plough, SPRI, Glaxo (contract), Bayer (contract/full), Micromass Comms, A4 Health **Systems**, North Carolina Community College System, NC State University, Aug 1995 to Oct 2017

- Architected lab information **management** system replacement, integrating LIMS, **SAP** QM, MES, document **management**, and SPC components. Led \$7.8M **implementation**, including transition and **data migration** planning.
- Managed \$18.5M aerosols insourcing program, completing on time and under budget, delivering seven products with optimized, error-proofed supply-chain.
- Executed multi-tier Trackwise change **management** rollout supporting critical elements like API changes, validations, master **data**, and stability testing.
- Developed and deployed barcode-enabled chain-of-custody software for sample tracking, integrating hardware and training to drive significant lab efficiencies.
- Led a \$14.5M 21 CFR 11 remediation project for 134 **systems**, delivering ahead of schedule and under budget while managing project managers and departmental teams, and capital project accounting.
- Developed and deployed division-wide database **systems** (HTML, Visual Basic) for SOP **management**, batch record design, and lean lab initiatives, aligned with GAMP 5 and regulatory standards.
- Designed and implemented risk-based system development and validation lifecycles, resulting in zero corporate audit and FDA inspection observations.
- Authored and executed strategies for lifecycle risk assessments, **quality** methodologies, and **quality management systems**, delivering training to enhance compliance and system adoption.
- Directed cross-functional teams in managing, testing, and delivering patient-driven healthcare web and print education materials.
- Created technical documentation, manuals, and online help for clinical and health **management** software, meeting JCAHO and HL7 standards.

EDUCATION

Master's certificate – Project **Management**, Villanova

BA (dual major – Political Science and English, magna cum laude), N.C. State University

AWARDS AND HONORS

Inspire Breakthrough Award (Merck, 2020)

Best-in-Class Performance Award (Merck, 2017)

World Class Supplier Award (Merck, 2016)

Performance awards, multiple

AFFILIATIONS

IEEE

ACM

Brandon Buchanan

- Pittsboro, NC, US

Contact Information

- wzs-1mu-rnz@mail.dice.com
- 4236505516

Work History

Total Work Experience: 8 years

- **Data** Workstream Lead / Senior Project Manager Gilead Sciences (Contracted Via RGP Consulting)
Sep 01, 2023
- Program Lead / Senior Project Manager (LIMS Projects) Moderna (Contracted Via RED Global)
Apr 01, 2023
- Senior Project Manager And **Data Migration** Technical Smith And Nephew (Contracted Via Vaco)
Aug 01, 2022
- Senior Project Manager And Technical Lead (Joint) Organon (Contracted Via Diversant)
Mar 01, 2022
- Senior Project Manager Bristol Myers Squibb (Contracted Via The Eliassen)
Oct 01, 2021
- Associate Director, **Data** Readiness (IPI/Product Lifecycle Merck)
Feb 01, 2019

- **Project Manager II/Senior Project Management Consultant Novo Nordisk**
May 01, 2018
- **CEO/Principal Consultant Throne Research LLC**
Oct 01, 2017

Education

- **North Carolina Outward Bound School**
- **W.G. Enloe High School**
- **Villanova University**
- **Bachelors** | North Carolina State University
- **Masters** | Villanova University

Skills

- **project management** - 30 years
- **data migration** - 28 years
- **qa** - 27 years
- **verification and validation** - 26 years
- **strategy** - 25 years
- **supply chain management** - 24 years
- **21 cfr part 11**
- **agile project management**
- **agile testing**
- **analytical skills**
- **anvisa**
- **auditing**
- **automation**
- **batch**
- **bom**
- **business objects data integrator**
- **business process improvement**
- **capa**
- **capital planning and management**

- change control
- cmmi
- computer system validation
- corrective and preventive action
- cross functional team leadership
- cybersecurity
- data analysis
- data architecture
- data governance
- data integrity
- data management
- data transformation
- database design
- databases
- defect resolution
- document management
- engineering
- etl tools
- extract
- fda
- gamp
- gmp
- good manufacturing practice
- gxp
- hipaa
- information security
- internal audit
- iso 13485
- java
- jcaho
- kaizen
- laboratory information management
- leadership
- lean manufacturing
- load
- management
- manufacturing
- master data management
- medical devices
- mes
- microsoft excel
- microsoft office
- microsoft project
- packaging
- pharmaceutical industry

- plm tools
- problem solving
- process improvement
- product release
- program **management**
- project planning
- **quality assurance**
- **quality** auditing
- **quality** control
- **quality** system
- regulatory affairs
- requirements analysis
- resource **management**
- **sap**
- **sap hana**
- **sap** products
- **sap** s4hana
- scrum
- security analysis
- security architecture design
- serialization
- six sigma
- software development
- software development life cycle
- sql
- **syniti**
- system architecture
- system integration
- **systems** analysis
- technology transfer
- test planning
- testing
- transform
- u.s. food and drug administration
- valiance
- validation
- vendor **management**
- waterfall project **management**
- windchill
- integration - 24 years
- troubleshooting - 24 years
- lims - 23 years
- planning - 23 years
- **quality management** - 23 years
- trackwise - 23 years

- **training** - 23 years
- **implementation** - 23 years
- **compliance** - 23 years
- **health care** - 23 years
- **software** - 23 years
- **budget** - 22 years
- **change management** - 22 years
- **cross-functional** - 22 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote or Hybrid
- Likely to Switch: False
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 0%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
 Security Clearance: False
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract - Corp-to-Corp
 - Contract - Independent
 - Contract - W2
 - Contract to Hire - Corp-to-Corp
 - Contract to Hire - Independent
 - Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://linkedin.com/in/brandonbuchanan>
- Dice:

<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/2749fa19cdd567793ab4f5d0568a4d98>